



June 2026 50th Year of Growth 1976 - 2026



Contact Email: doncastergardenclubinc@gmail.com

Web Address: www.doncastergardenclubaus.com

The DGC committee meeting was held on 3 June 2026 at 7.30 pm.

The next DGC meeting will be held on **Wednesday, 10 June 2026**
7.30 pm at the RSL Hall , cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street. Doors open at 7.15pm

The speaker is Rachel Maggiore, Pruning Roses

Committee Members 2026

President

Avril Clark

0402 478 302

doncastergardenclubinc@gmail.com

Vice-President & Speaker

Bookings:

Vacant

Treasurer:

Dr Margaret Salter

Secretary:

Virgina Roberts & Connie Lee

secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Fund Raising Co-Ordinator:

Anita Lizza

Newsletter:

Rohini Padey

newseditor@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Reinhard

Esther Sim

Ray Brett

President's message June 2026

My garden has been loving the rain and I hope yours has too. I have been busy planting my vegetable garden with carrots, parsnips, spring onions, broad beans, snow peas, silver beet and broccoli.

Before I planted I had covered my vegetable beds with Rockdust, diluted Biochar and Populate (from Neutrog) Everything is looking lush and is growing slowly!

I was interested to read in the newsletter The Eastern Melburnian that a new biochar facility has opened in Lysterfield to supply the farmers in the Yarra valley as it provides farm soils with better water retention and nutrient storage. Biochar is certainly becoming more widely known.

If you are interested in gardening information don't forget to look on Bulleen Art and Garden's website where they have great fact sheets about everything you might want to know. Also

Sustainable Gardening Australia has excellent fact sheets too.

Keep warm and happy gardening!

Avril



Speaker for May - Beekeeper Paul Davies from Heathmont Honey



Paul shared the story of his lifelong passion for bees, which began in New Zealand at age 13 after opening his first wild beehive on his grandfather's farm. With support from his family and guidance from mentors, Paul gradually built his beekeeping skills, overcoming many memorable mishaps along the way — from honey spraying across his mother's kitchen to thousands of bees invading his father's garage during honey extraction.



After moving to Melbourne, Paul became involved in the local beekeeping community and was mentored by beekeeper Ian Brown, who gave him the kick-start he needed to establish his business, Heathmont Honey in 2004.



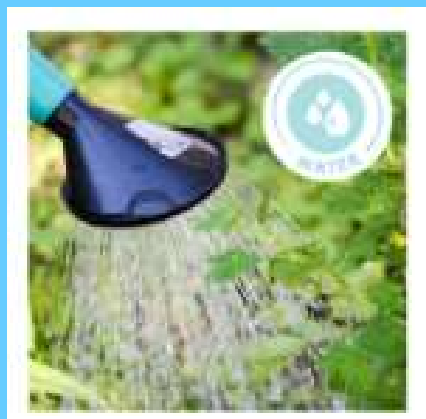
Starting with farmers markets, Paul steadily expanded his operation and now manages 220 hives across five Victorian sites, supplying farmers markets and wineries in the Yarra Valley.

Paul also spoke about the challenges facing beekeepers, particularly the arrival of varroa mite in Australia in 2022. He explained that unmanaged hives will be destroyed by the mite, although Australian native bees are unaffected. He highlighted how Australian beekeepers can learn from overseas experience and discussed new bee breeding programs in the United States that aim to improve bees' natural resistance to varroa mite.

Paul concluded by answering questions on swarm collection, bee lifespans and varroa mite management.

Ryset Order

As requested by a few members we will place a Ryset order again in the month of June. All re-orders for out of stock items and any new orders must be **sent to Avril by the 10th June** at doncastergardenclubinc@gmail.com
There will be NO further Ryset orders until next year.



Water

Winter is here but don't assume you can stop watering the vegie patch just because the skies are cloudy and rain is more frequent! Light rainfall might not reach the root zone of your food plants, so keep poking your finger into the soil and if it doesn't feel like a damp sponge then give your patch a drink. Watch this short video about watering your veggies

https://mysmartgarden.org.au/watering-your-veggies/?mc_cid=74bdd63e2a&mc_eid=c029f2daa3

Upcoming calendar events:

Upcoming Committee Meeting:	03 June	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Upcoming Meeting:	10 June	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Following Committee Meeting:	01 July	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Following Meeting:	08 July	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Speaker at the July meeting:
Bruno Tigani on Commercial Vegetable seed industry

Hello Gardeners All

What a relief for the gardens and farms who have received drought breaking rain. I have measured 73.1mm (29th). More is predicted. When one grows some vegetables, none of which are drought tolerant, one realises the necessity of good rain for our vegetable farmers or else a good supply of irrigation water - often less good when there's a drought.

There has been a small flush of late roses which are spectacular. 2 cerise pink zygocactii flowered one after the other and 2 azalea are blooming, out of season I think, as is the pink Bella Donna (naked lady) lily.

I feel proud of the Red Papaya tree which has finally set 2 papaya (female flowers) after I watched male flowers open and drop all summer. I was feeling there was something lacking so now am confident but I will add another handful of Neutrog (Dead Horse) fertiliser to the 50 litre pot which also has a self sown tomato plant which has also decided to set fruit. Both plants will use it.

Silverbeet, Chokos and Peruvian Cucumbers are having a late burst of slower productivity after the harshness of so many 35-43 degree days.

I have cut back the dead stalks of the skirret, excess leafy growth of sweet potato vines and will do the dying asparagus greenery any day. The asparagus needs manure and compost to boost it for the spring crop.

The garlic and leeks are doing well and some of the broccoli is starting to head. The pea and beetroot plants are slowly growing. More sun would help.

The small crops on the orange and Mandarin trees are colouring. Both had bumper crops last year which virtually predicated a smaller one this year. The fig trees also had small numbers of fruit due to the extreme heat, with a late burst of fruit in the autumn.

I find it so rewarding to see the success of produce from the effort to do the gardening. It is also exciting to see the first of fruit or veg from setting flowers or roots popping out of the ground when ready.

Till next time - happy gardening. Pauline

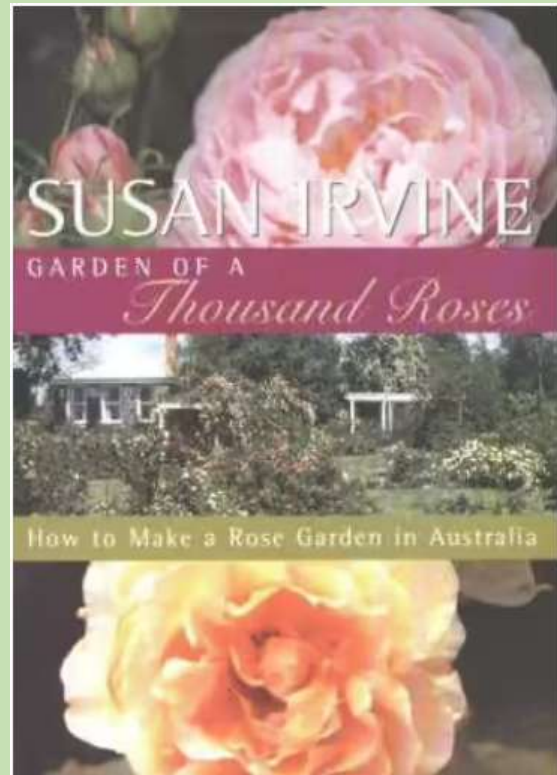
From my Bookshelf June 2026

Garden of a thousand roses: Making a rose garden in Australia. Susan Irvine

Susan Irvine was Headmistress of Lauriston Girls School from 1972 – 1982. When she retired she purchased an old, almost derelict stone cottage on 170 acres on the Calder Highway. Her plan was to plant a rose garden from scratch and this is the fascinating story of her journey.

She started with very limited knowledge of roses and of gardening in general and we learn with Susan as she progresses on this journey. It was here, early in my gardening career, that I learnt about Rugosa roses, David Austin roses and the amazing Australian rosarian Alister Clark who bred such beautiful roses for the Australian climate. Sadly they have become very hard to find and much of his breeding information has been lost.

This is a wonderfully written journal of Susan's garden that provides so much rich information about the making of a garden, not to mention the mistakes and funny anecdotes.
Well worth reading.



What seeds to plant in June

Fruit and Veg	Herbs	Flowers
 Asparagus Crowns Direct sow, ready in 390-420 days.	 Garlic Direct sow, ready in 200-300 days.	 Roses Bare-root stock, flowers in 70-100 days.
 Blackberry Canes Direct sow, fruits on second year canes.	 Shallots Direct sow, ready in 120 days.	 Poppy Direct sow, flowers in 140 days.
 Peas Direct sow, ready in 60-80 days.	 Mustard Direct sow, ready in 30-60 days.	 Viola Transplanted, flowers in 110-120 days.

Gardening in Winter

Winter is a time for gardeners to focus on protecting tender plants, maintaining soil health, and preparing for spring.

The benefits of winter planting are

-Less Pest Pressure: Common garden pests are less active during winter, reducing the risk of pest damage to crops.

-Reduced Watering: Cooler temperatures and increased rainfall mean less frequent watering, saving time and resources

-Extended Growing Season: By planting in winter, you can expand your growing season and enjoy fresh produce throughout the year

Here are some gardening tips for winter:

Frost Protection: Avoid pruning frost-damaged growth until spring to protect healthy foliage.

Winter Planting: Consider planting hardy vegetables, herbs, and flowers that thrive in cold conditions.

Pruning: Prune deciduous trees and roses while dormant to prepare them for growth in spring.

Mulching: Use organic mulch to protect plant roots, suppress winter weeds, and retain soil moisture.

Screening: Plant evergreen magnolias, pittosporums, or native varieties to provide privacy and structure throughout the year.

These strategies not only help in protecting your garden from winter's challenges but also set the stage for a vibrant garden come spring.

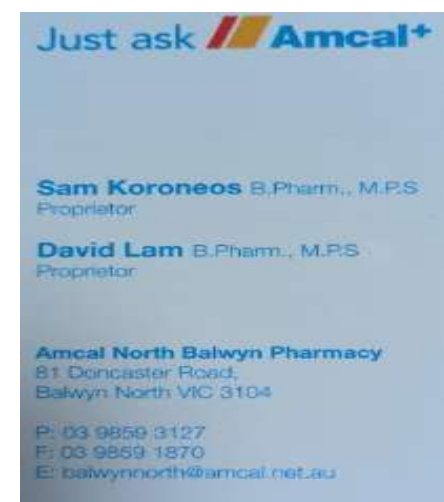
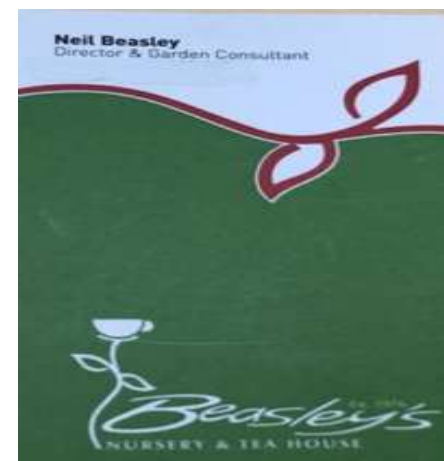
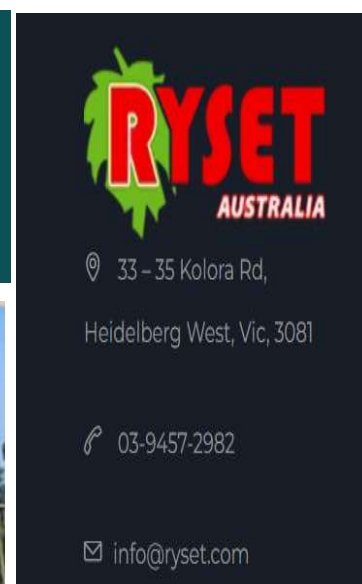


DGC Life Members

Gerda van der Peet
Doug Brewer
Toni Myers
Gayle McCann

Ted Page
Joanne Driver
Elsie Carter
Bev Turner
Franziska Kung





The Ryset Catalogue can be found online:

<https://ryset.com>

The Club receives wholesale prices which means discounts of up to 60-70%

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